T2: Threshold Structure and Edge-to-Vortex Transition

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Contents

T2: Threshold Structure and Edge-to-Vortex Transition — Conclusion Summary 2

T2: Threshold Structure and Edge-to-Vortex Transition — Conclusion Summary

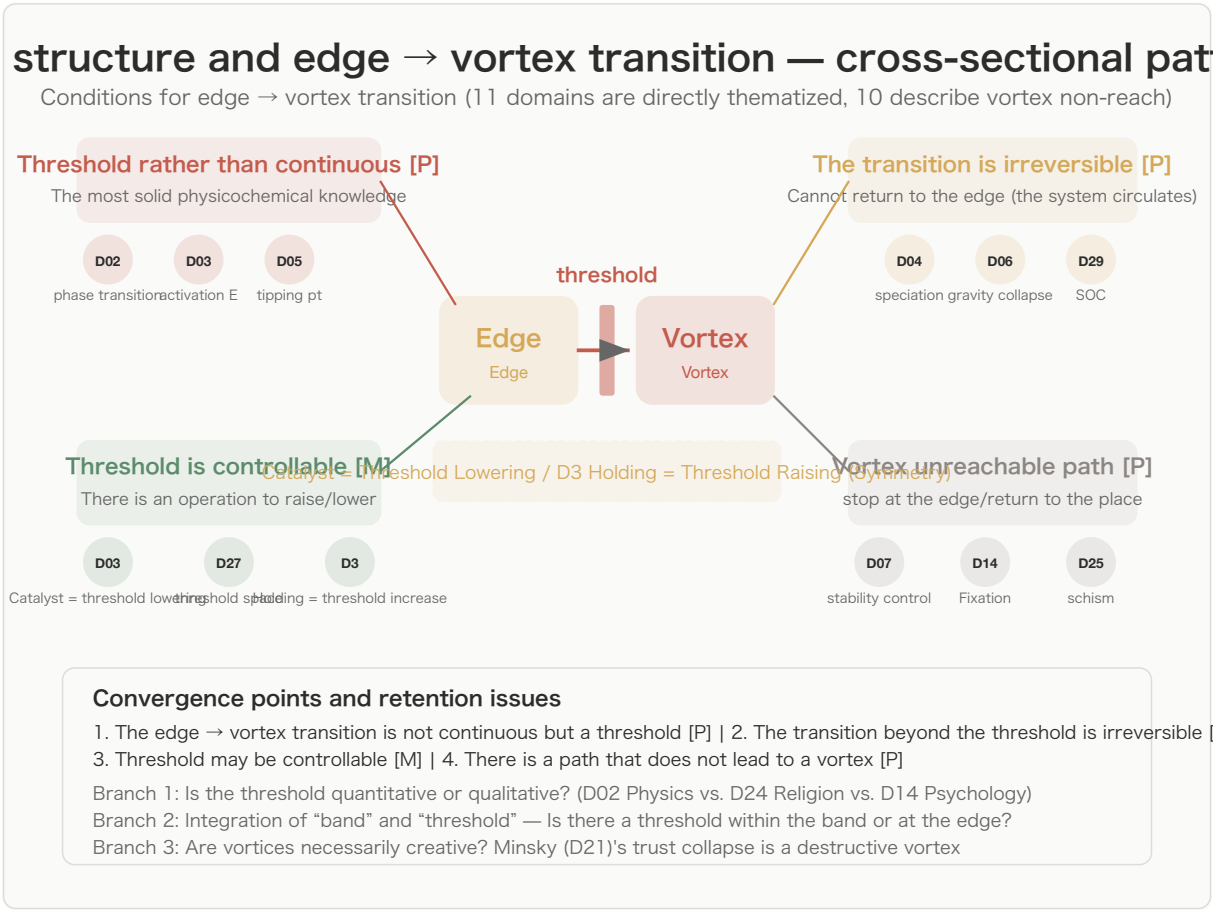


Figure 1: T2: Threshold Structure and Edge-to-Vortex Transition — Conclusion Summary

11 domains directly thematize threshold transitions. An additional 10 domains describe non-arrival-at-vortex pathways.

- **The edge-to-vortex transition is threshold-like, not continuous**: One of the most robust cross-domain findings from the physical and chemical sciences
- **Transitions beyond the threshold are irreversible**: Once entered, the vortex cannot return to the edge — though the system as a whole may cycle
- **The threshold can be “controllable” in some cases**: Catalysts are threshold-lowering devices; Containment is a threshold-raising attitude
- **“Pathways that never reach the vortex” exist**: The five stages do not guarantee arrival at the vortex; routes that stop at the edge are also part of the model

A tension exists between “edge as band” (T1 finding) and “transition as threshold.” Bands have width; thresholds point to a spot. The symmetry between catalyst (lowering the threshold) and Containment (raising the threshold) may be theorized as a control mechanism for “staying at the edge” versus “entering the vortex.”

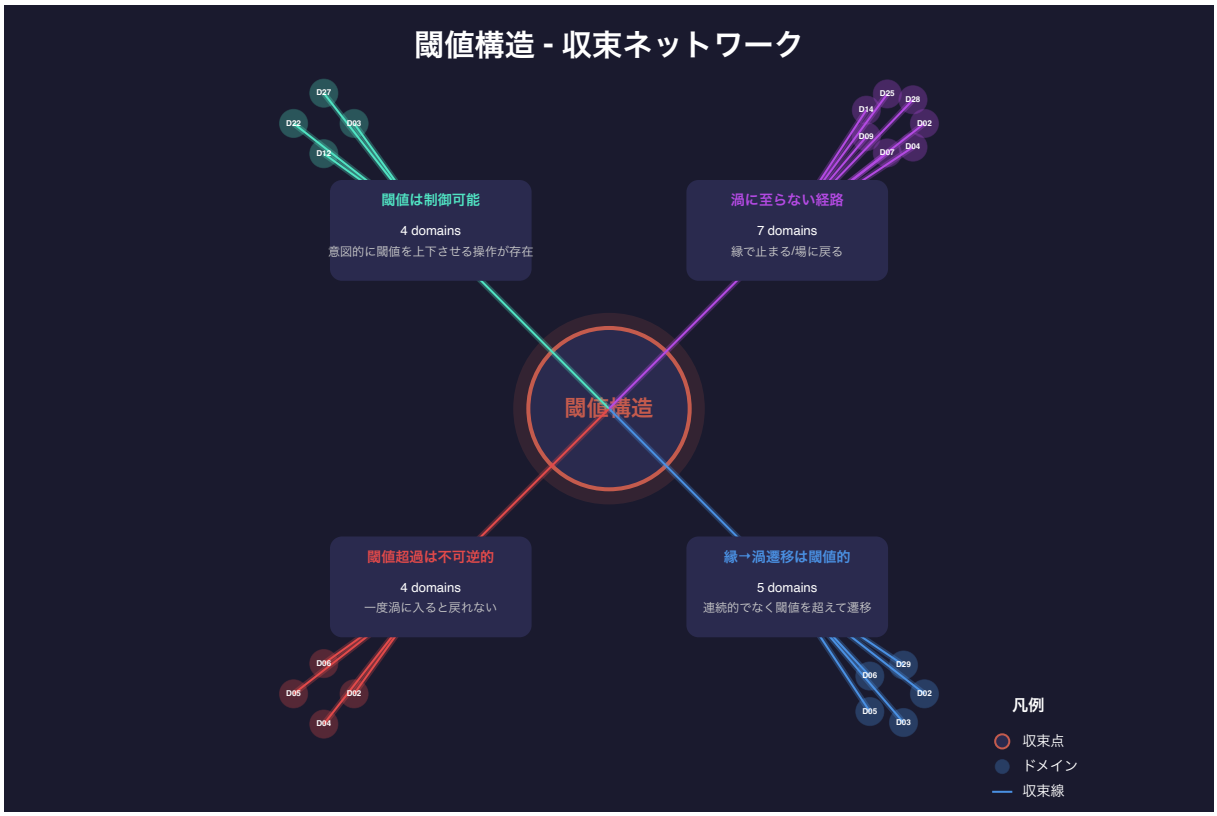


Figure 2: T2 Threshold Structure Convergence Network